# CHRISTOPHER BLACKWELL

**GIS SPECIALIST • GEOSPATIAL ANALYSIS • REMOTE SENSING**

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## PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

GIS specialist with hands-on experience in geospatial analysis, remote sensing, field data collection, and environmental conservation. Integrates satellite imagery, GPS surveys, and habitat datasets into defensible ArcGIS workflows, applying raster/vector analysis, spatial QA/QC, cartography, and statistical methods to support research and conservation decisions.

## EDUCATION

**B.S. Environmental Science & Resource Management** | *Expected May 2027*
**California State University Channel Islands, Camarillo, CA**
Earth Systems emphasis • Environmental Technology Certificate (Completed 2026)
Relevant coursework: GIS, Intermediate GIS, Remote Sensing, Environmental Statistics, Data Visualization, R Programming, Geomorphology & Hydrology

## EXPERIENCE

**Summer SURF Fellow — Geospatial Analysis | California State University Channel Islands**
*June 2026–Present*

- Analyze 2,500+ hectares affected by the 2025 Palisades Fire in ArcGIS Pro to evaluate ecosystem recovery and habitat conditions for endangered tidewater goby populations.
- Integrate satellite imagery, GPS field surveys, and habitat layers; perform raster/vector analysis, georeferencing, and spatial QA/QC across multi-source datasets.
- Collaborate with the Resource Conservation District of the Santa Monica Mountains and U.S. Fish & Wildlife Service to translate findings into conservation recommendations.

**GIS Tutor | California State University Channel Islands**
*August 2024–Present*

- Lead weekly GIS labs covering spatial analysis, ArcGIS Pro workflows, cartography, and geospatial data management.
- Mentor students in geoprocessing methods, data organization, troubleshooting, and communication of spatial results.

**Student GIS Consultant | California State University Channel Islands**
*August 2024–Present*

- Support client-based projects through GIS troubleshooting, spatial visualization, map production, and workflow documentation.
- Translate client needs into reproducible geospatial analyses, technical documentation, and decision-ready cartographic products.

**Environmental Education Instructor | Scouts of America, Catalina Island**
*August 2022–August 2024*

- Conducted field data collection, GPS navigation, and ecological surveys in marine and coastal ecosystems.
- Delivered hands-on environmental science instruction connecting field observations with ecosystem monitoring and spatial thinking.

## SELECTED GEOSPATIAL PROJECTS

**Post-Wildfire Remote Sensing:** Compared Sierra Nevada bee pollinator patterns before and after the 2020 Complex Fire using spatial analysis, remote-sensing inputs, and statistical modeling.

**Ventura County Seismic Analysis:** Mapped and analyzed a 20-year earthquake dataset in ArcGIS Pro to identify spatial-temporal patterns in event frequency and magnitude.

**Species Distribution Assessment:** Mapped Kendall Warm Springs dace distribution and critical habitat to support conservation prioritization and funding allocation.

**Ventura Land Trust Site Prioritization:** Completed a parcel-based geospatial analysis and technical report evaluating candidate sites against client-defined conservation criteria; recommended priority sites and documented the GIS workflow.

**Theme Park Seasonal Heat Analysis:** Used thermal remote-sensing imagery to compare heat differences across rides at Disneyland and Universal Studios and identify which attractions were hottest during different times of year.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**GIS PLATFORMS**
ArcGIS Pro • ArcMap • ArcGIS Online • QGIS

**SPATIAL ANALYSIS**
Raster & vector analysis • Georeferencing • Spatial interpolation • Network analysis

**REMOTE SENSING**
Satellite imagery • Multispectral analysis • Land-cover classification • Change detection

**DATA & DESIGN**
R • Statistical analysis • Data visualization • Cartography • Microsoft Excel

## RESEARCH & FIELD

**DATA COLLECTION**
GPS field surveys • Ecological surveys • Habitat data • Field protocols

**DATA QUALITY**
Spatial QA/QC • Multi-source data integration • Workflow documentation

## PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

**ESRI USER CONFERENCE**
Attended technical sessions on GIS workflows, cartography and map imagery, geoprocessing tips, and emerging spatial-analysis practices; networked with geospatial professionals through the Esri Young Professionals Network.

## LEADERSHIP & AFFILIATIONS

- Elected Committee Member, Ventura County Air Pollution Control District
- Esri Young Professionals Network
- American Association of Geographers
- Eagle Scout
- Student Organizing Committee Board Member